



Office of
Deputy Commissioner
of Maritime Affairs

THE REPUBLIC OF LIBERIA

LIBERIA MARITIME AUTHORITY

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MARINE SECURITY ADVISORY – 02/2022

Subject: Security situation in the Black Sea and the Azov Sea

Dear Owners/Operators/Company Security Officers/Masters:

Due to the escalating security situation in and around the Exclusive Economic Zones (EEZ) and territorial waters of the Ukraine and the Russian Federation in the Black Sea and the Azov Sea, Masters of all Liberian flagged vessels currently in the Black Sea Ports of the Russian Federation and Ukraine should ensure that the security level of their vessels is equivalent to Ship Security Level III and take precautions in accordance with their Ship Security Plans. Masters of all other ships in the Black Sea should ensure that the security level of their vessels is equivalent to Ship Security Level 2, and take precautions in accordance with their Ship Security Plans.

Vessels' movements are reported to be prohibited in the Azov Sea beginning 24 February 2022. No attempt should be made to access the Azov Sea.

Vessels operating in the Black Sea, specifically those near the EEZs of Ukraine and the Russian Federation, should avoid Ukrainian and Russian waters. Commercial operations within the EEZs of Turkey, Bulgaria and Romania remain unaffected at this time.

Any vessel currently within Ukrainian and Russian ports of the Black Sea are encouraged to immediately leave if it is safe to do so and in accordance with local authorities guidelines and instructions, if available. Operators and Masters should ensure that any planned operations or voyages do not take the vessel into any area, or engage in any activity, that would expose her to the risk of ongoing military operations. Vessels should ensure they are broadcasting on AIS and clearly state their intentions across VHF. Any vessels challenged by military vessels should comply fully with instructions.

This is a dynamic situation and changes may occur at any time. Owners, Operators, Company Security Officers and Masters are suggested to monitor the developments and to liaise closely with local port agents and P&I correspondents for the latest information on facility conditions, dangerous sea areas and temporary port closures and navigational restrictions.

Operators and Masters should complete a Risk Assessment prior to entering the Black Sea area.

All attacks and suspicious sightings should be reported to Liberia Maritime Security.

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